Retrieved Text Is Evidence, Not an Instruction Channel

Summary

Retrieved documents and web pages can contain text that looks like a command to the model. [chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc] [chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f]

Instruction boundary

The source note recommends marking retrieved content as untrusted source material, keeping application instructions separate, and telling the model not to follow instructions embedded in evidence. [chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc] [chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f]

It also recommends restricting which tools may be called and validating tool arguments independently. [chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc] [chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f]

Limits and tests

This boundary does not make prompt injection impossible; the note describes it as a way to reduce confusion between the question, instructions, and analyzed material. [chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc] [chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f]

The note recommends hostile-document tests that check whether the researcher summarizes factual content without carrying out embedded requests. [chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc] [chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f]

Scope

This example reports the documented design guidance and makes no claim of complete protection. [chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc] [chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f]

Diagrams

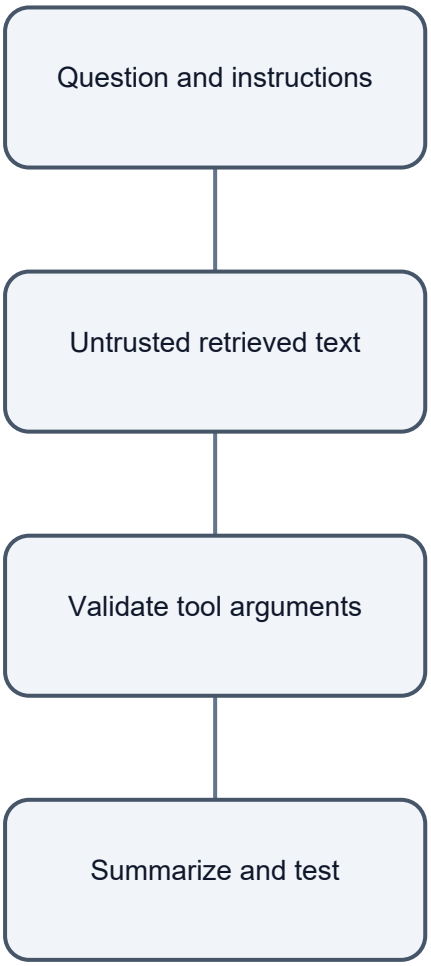


Diagram 1

Audio summary

Listen to the 72-second narrated summary

References

- Citation ID: chunk:b1d95c2036c9ad9ebdcc - Source: 19_untrusted_retrieved_text.md
- Citation ID: chunk:784ee6e2fdd2a6058d2f - Source: 19_untrusted_retrieved_text.md